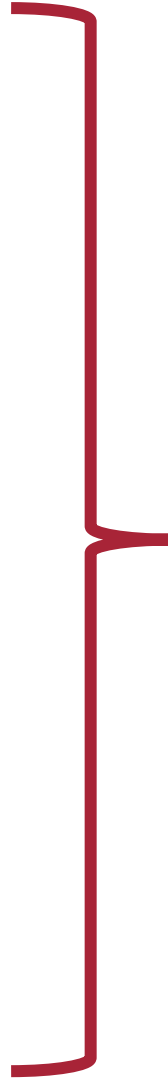




Monticello Archaeology Lab
Ceramics Lecture
Field School 2026

GENERAL TERMS TO KNOW

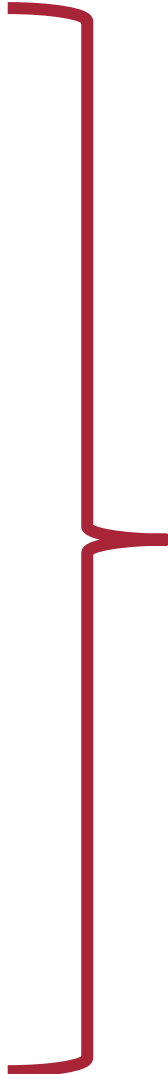
- Paste
- Inclusions
- Porosity
- Glaze
- Crazing
- Slip
- Decoration
- Manufacturing Technique



Types of Attributes, or characteristics

GENERAL TERMS TO KNOW

- **Handpainting**
 - Underglaze
 - Overglaze
- **Transferprinting**
 - Underglaze
 - Overglaze
- **Slipping**
 - Hand-applied
 - Factory-made
- **Molding**
- **Incising**
- **Impressing (e.g., Cord-Marked)**



Types of Decorative Techniques

DECORATION HIGHLIGHTS

Factory-made Slipware

1770s-1840s



Jefferson Patterson Museum, Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland

Molded Edges



DAACS.org

Handpainting



Jefferson Patterson Museum, Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland & DAACS.org

Transferprinting

Post-1750



Jefferson Patterson Museum, Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland & DAACS.org

A NOTE ON DATES...



- We ask that you know date ranges for the common wares found here

BUT

- Dates are based on manufacturing periods and/or known access in a particular region
- Thus, dates are context-dependent
- Know that wherever you are in your archaeological journey, there will always be new dates

4 MAIN MATERIAL TYPES

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Coarse Earthenwares
 - *Indigenous, Colonoware, Imported (European), Local Lead-glazed (American)*
- Refined Earthenwares
 - *Tin-Enameled (Delft), Whieldon, Creamware, Pearlware, Whiteware, Ironstone/White Granite, Yellow Ware, Bennington/Rockingham*

Stonewares (1200°-1350°)

- Imported
 - *Westerwald, British Brown/Fulham, White Salt-glazed, Dry-bodied (Black Basalt, Rosso Antico)*
- Local
 - *American Blue and Grey*

Porcelains (1300°-1450°)

- Chinese
- Porcellaneous

MATERIAL TYPE OVERVIEW

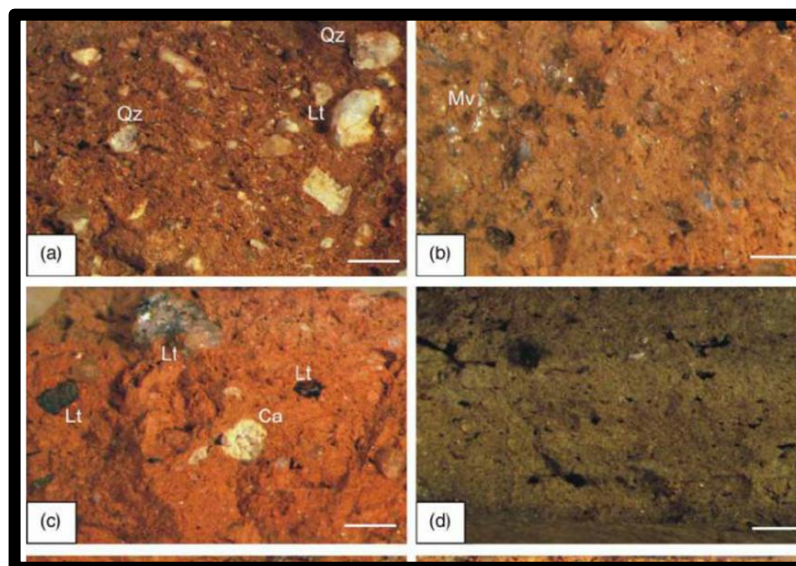
Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- **Coarse Earthenwares**

- *Softer paste*
- *More/larger inclusions*
- *Very porous*
- *Lead glaze*

Microscopic images of coarse earthenware paste

🔗 [Páez and Sardi 2014](#)



Redware

National Park Service, Independence National Historical Park, Inde-57209

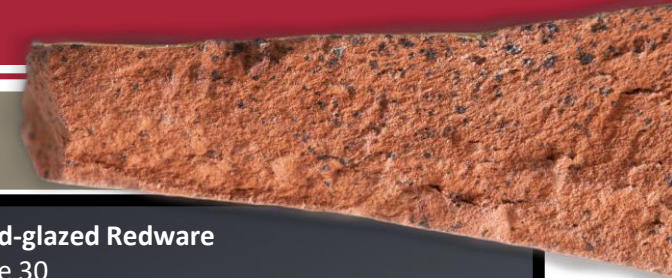
North Midlands/Staffordshire Slipware
DAACS.org



Colonoware
DAACS.org



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT



Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Coarse Earthenwares
 - **Redware (1600-1900)**
 - *Generic term for a red-bodied CEW*
 - *Lead-glazed or unglazed*
 - *Imported or locally made*
 - *New scholarship: Laser ablation & XRF*

Redware Flowerpot
Drayton Hall (DAACS.org)



Redware Chamberpot
Colonial Williamsburg



American Lead-glazed Redware
Monticello Site 30



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Coarse Earthenwares

- **Buckley (1720-1775, British)**

- *Agatized red body*
- *Wheel thrown*
- *Opaque black to very dark brown lead glaze*
- *Utilitarian forms, undecorated*



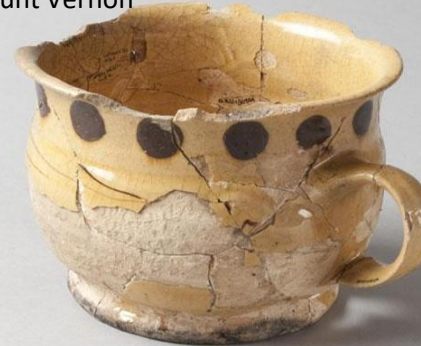
Buckley butter pot
Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland



- **N. Midlands/Staffordshire Slipware (1670-1795, British)**

- *Buff-colored paste (slightly agatized) with hematite, black and red grog inclusions*
- *Wheel thrown or press molded*
- *Translucent lead glaze (appears yellow)*
- *Utilitarian forms and tablewares*
- *Slip decorations*

N. Midlands/Staff'shire Slipware porringer
Mount Vernon



N. Midlands/Staffordshire Slipware Tblware
Drayton Hall



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Coarse Earthenwares

- **Eastern Virginia/Tidewater**

Eastern Virginia Mug
Jamestown



Eastern Virginia Milk Pan



- **Western Virginia/Piedmont**

Variety of Western Virginia sherds
Monticello



- **PHAB (Philadelphia, Alexandria, & Baltimore)**

PHAB Flat Tableware
Monticello



PHAB Hollow Tableware
Drayton Hall



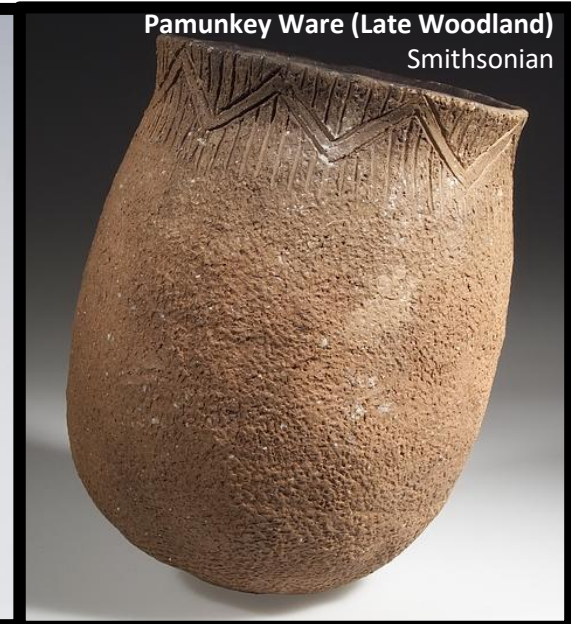
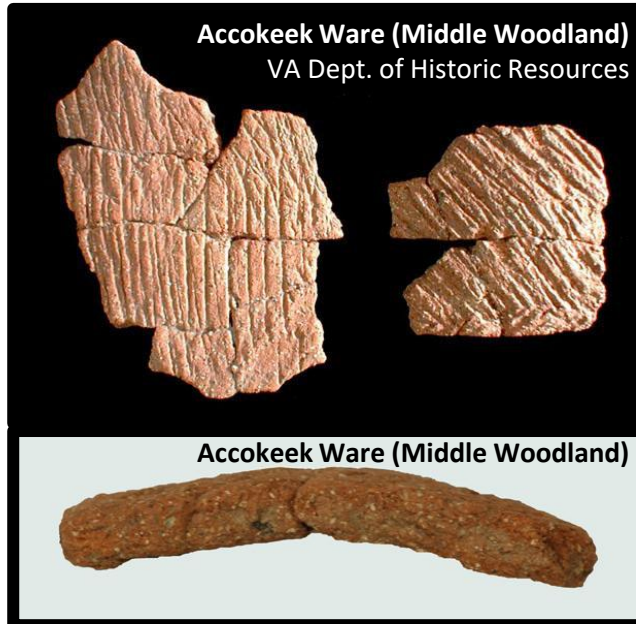
WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Coarse Earthenwares

- **Native American/Indigenous (Woodland Period, 1200 BC – AD 1600)**

- *Brown to gray paste with coarse inclusions*
- *Regionally distinct in inclusion type and surface treatments*
- *Unglazed*
- *Utilitarian hollow forms*
- *Surface treatments: corn cob, cord, cloth, finger-impressed, plain, punctated*



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Coarse Earthenwares

- **Colonoware (c. 1650-1830)**

- *Wide regional variability in paste, form, and surface treatments*
- **Usually* unglazed*
- *Utilitarian forms, tablewares, some possible teawares (and some mimicry of European forms)*
- *Surface treatments: mostly plain, some mimicry of European decorations*
- *Produced and used by Indigenous and African potters in the American Southeast & Mid-Atlantic*



Colonoware jar
Curriboo Plantation, SC



© E. Price, Mount Vernon Preservation

Colonoware bowl/pan
Mount Vernon, VA



Colonoware bowl
Accotink, VA



Crenulated shallow colonoware bowl
Drayton Hall, SC

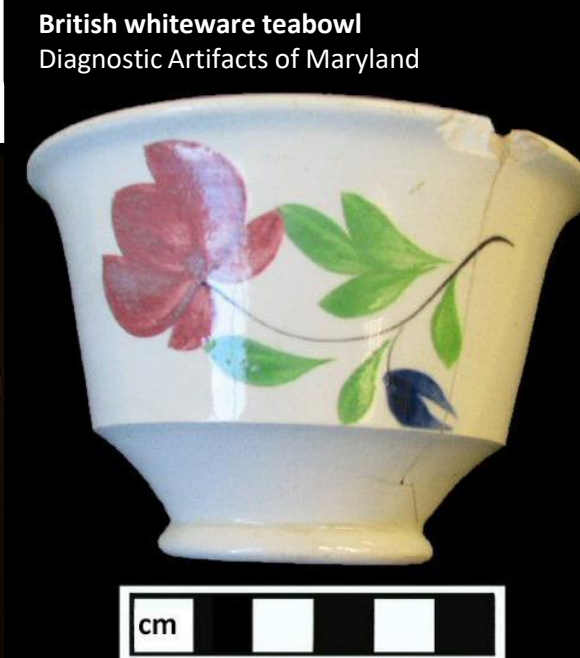


MATERIAL TYPE OVERVIEW

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

• Refined Earthenwares

- *Harder paste than CEW w/ minimal inclusions*
- *Most cream to white-colored paste*
- *Lead and alkaline-lead glazes*
- *Most are press-molded*
- *Tablewares, teawares, and chamberpots*
- *Wide variety of decorative techniques*
- *Heavily impacted by mid-18th-century technological advancements & consumer revolution*



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

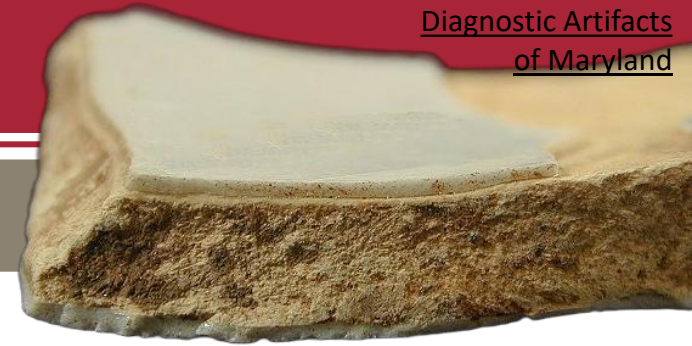
Diagnostic Artifacts
of Maryland

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Refined Earthenwares

- Tin-Enameled: Delft, Faience, Majolica (1600-1800)**

- *“Transitional” refined earthenware*
- *Lower firing temperature relative to REWs*
- *Soft paste, buff to pink, chalky*
- *Lead and Tin-oxide glaze; thick, opaque, pops off easily*



Delft bowl, handpainted blue
Monticello, Building o



Delft tableware, handpainted blue
Monticello, Building o



Delft flat tableware, handpainted blue
Diagnostic Artifacts of
Maryland



cm

Faience drug jar
Monticello, Building s



CM

Delft jar, handpainted polychrome
Jamestown



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Diagnostic Artifacts
of Maryland

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Refined Earthenwares

- Creamware (1762-1820, British)**

- Called "Queens Ware" - Major benchmark in British ceramic industry*
- Cream-colored paste*
- Lead glaze, pools slightly green*
- Small crazing*
- Mostly molded edge decorations (feather edge, scalloped edge)*
- Some handpainting, slipwares, early transferprinting*



Creamware Chamberpot



Feather edge creamware plate
Monticello, Building o



Scalloped "Royal Pattern" creamware plate
Monticello



Handpainted "King's Rose" creamware teabowl
Drayton Hall



Molded beaded creamware hollow teaware
Monticello, Building o



Factory-made slipware creamware
Mug



Chipstone Foundation

WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Refined Earthenwares

- Whieldon-type (1740-1775, British)**

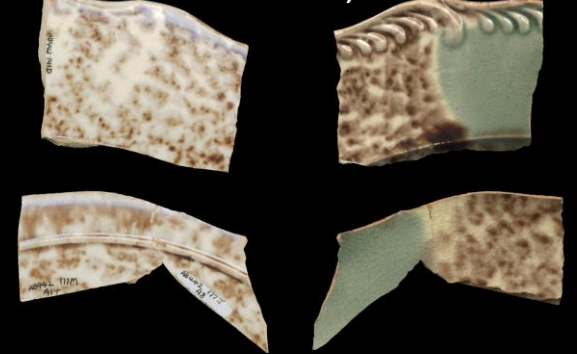
- Essentially creamware + a distinct decoration
- Cream-colored paste, lead glaze, same forms
- Distinctive decorations:
 - Painted: "Tortoiseshell" or "Clouded"
 - Molded: Dot, Diaper, Basketweave; Feather-edged



Clouded, tortoiseshell, and molded (dot, diaper, basketweave) Whieldon ware plate



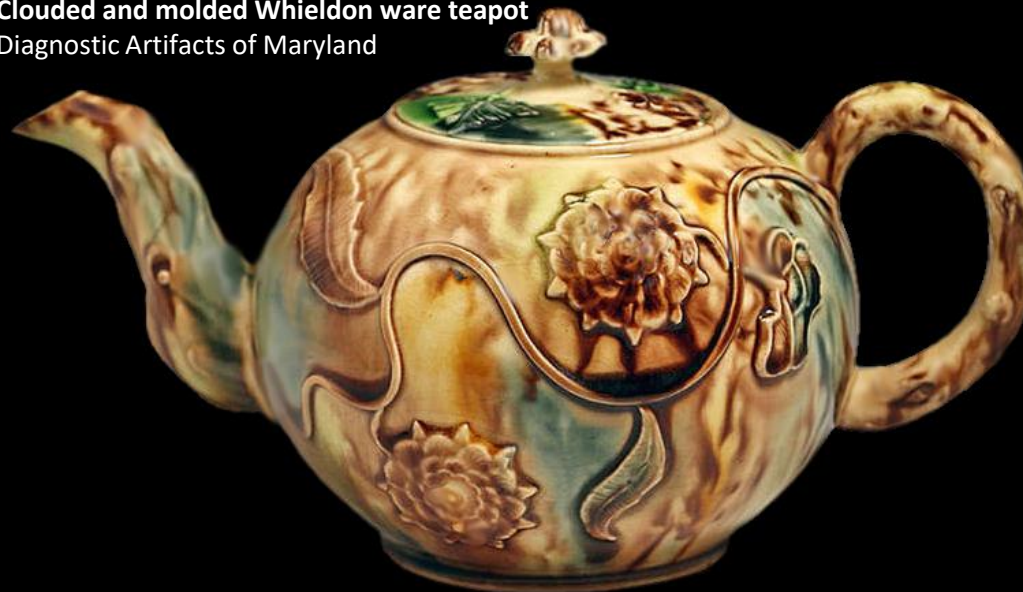
Clouded, tortoiseshell, and molded (feather-edged) Whieldon ware flat tableware, Monticello Site 8



Tortoiseshell Whieldon ware teabowl
Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland



Clouded and molded Whieldon ware teapot
Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Refined Earthenwares

- Pearlware (1775-1830, British)**

- Replaces creamware*
- Similar cream-colored paste with few inclusions*
- Lead glaze with cobalt-oxide added – green-blue tint to glaze and pools green-blue*
- Wide range of decorations: Handpainted blue & polychrome, transferprinting, slipware, molded edges*

Polychrome
Warm



Shell edge pearlware flat tblware
Monticello



Handpainted blue pearlware teabowl
Monticello



Handpainted polychrome "warm"
saucer
Monticello



Molded & Handpainted edge pearlware platter
Monticello



Transferprinted Willow pattern
Pearlware flat tableware
Monticello



Factory-made slipware pearlware mug
Winterthur Museum



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Refined Earthenwares

- Whiteware (post-1820, British)**

- Replaces pearlware*
- Similar cream- to white-colored paste with few inclusions, slightly more dense than pearlware*
- Lead or alkaline-lead glaze appearing bright white to light blue/gray; pools blue-gray*
- Larger crazing*
- Wide range of decorations: Handpainted blue & polychrome, transferprinting, slipware, molded edges, sponged*

Polychrome
Cool



Hdptd polychrome "cool" flat whiteware tblware
Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland



Willow transferprint whiteware plate
Drayton Hall



Sponged whiteware saucer
Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland



Brown transferprinted whiteware plate
Chipstone



Molded edge whiteware plate
Chipstone



Factory-made slipware whiteware mug, Chipstone



Shell edge whiteware platter, Diag. MD

WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

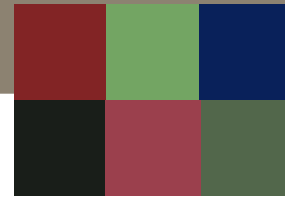
Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Refined Earthenwares

- Ironstone/White Granite (post-1840, British/American)**

- Doesn't really replace whiteware, but is the next version of it*
- Very dense paste buff- to white-colored*
- Alkaline-lead glaze usually w/ opacifiers (calcium, zinc, or tin) to make surface appear bright white (often very thick and "gloopy")*
- Larger crazing, appearance of cracked ice*
- Pools more on a gray side, can still have a blue tint*
- Decorations: less delicate molding, luster, decalcomania, transferprinting, handpainting, gilding, sponged*

Polychrome
Cool



Sponged & painted ironstone teabowl



Sponged & painted ironstone plate
Winterthur

Molded ironstone saucer

Diag. MD



Molded ironstone teabowl

Diag. MD



Transferprint & molded ironstone teapot

Winterthur



Decal & Gilded ironstone pitcher



Lustered ironstone creamware &
sugar container



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Earthenwares (900°-1200°)

- Refined Earthenwares

- **Yellow Ware (1825-1900s, British/American)**

- *Similar buff- to white-colored dense paste as whiteware and ironstone*
 - *Lead glaze that is translucent, so it appears yellow – more brown-yellow than creamware (green-yellow) and denser paste*
 - *Mostly utilitarian or simple tablewares*
 - *Minimal decoration – simpler factory-made slipwares*



- **Bennington/Rockingham (1830-1900, British/American)**

- *Essentially yellow ware with distinct decoration*
 - *Mottled or streaked iron-based glaze*
 - *More elaborate molded decorations*
 - *More variety of forms, including teawares and fancier tablewares*



MATERIAL TYPE OVERVIEW

Stonewares (1200°-1350°)

- *Not porous*
- Usually salt-glazed or unglazed (“bisque” fired)
 - Salt-glazing: look for pitted surfaces with “orange peel” appearance
- No crazing
- Typical form types differ by specific wares

Westerwald/Rhenish Stoneware
Winterthur Museum



American “Blue & Gray” Jar



Black Basalt saucer and teacup



White salt glaze stoneware tablewares



American stoneware “dipped” mugs
Chipstone



Bristol Glaze jug
Chipstone



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Stonewares (1200°-1350°)

- **Westerwald/Rhenish (1600-1775, German)**

- *Grey to tan paste with bluish-gray surface*
- *Salt-glazed*
- *Wheel thrown*
- *Often elaborate decoration: cordoning, molding, incising, handpainting (rich blues and purples)*
- *Both utilitarian and tableware forms*

Westerwald/Rhenish handpainted & incised
Monticello



Westerwald/Rhenish handpainted, sprig-molded, cordoned chamberpot
Diag. MD



Westerwald/Rhenish handpainted & cordoned mug
Drayton Hall



Westerwald/Rhenish handpainted, cordoned, incised, sprig-molded "GR" jug
Winterthur



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Diagnostic Artifacts
of Maryland

Stonewares (1200°-1350°)

- **British Brown/Fulham (1671-1775, British)**

- *Grey to light tan paste (more tan than German stonewares) sometimes w/ iron oxide*
- *Can have hematite (black specks) inclusions*
- *Wheel thrown*
- *Salt glaze*
- *Mostly utilitarian forms; some mugs*
- *Little decoration – some cordoning or incising*



British Brown/Fulham mug
Chipstone



British Brown/Fulham storage vessel
Drayton Hall



British Brown/Fulham jug
Mount Vernon



British Brown/Fulham jug
Monticello, Building o



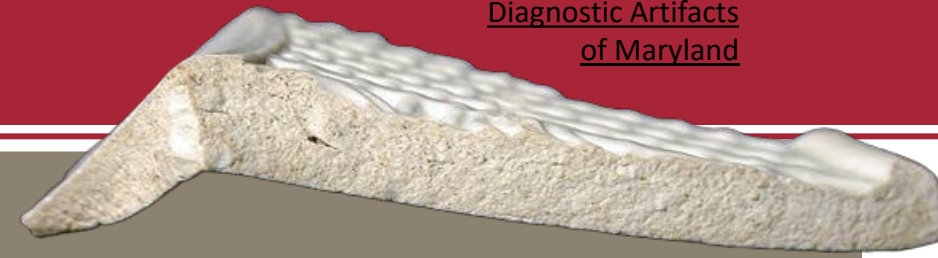
WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Diagnostic Artifacts
of Maryland

Stonewares (1200°-1350°)

• White Salt Glaze (1720-1805, British)

- *White to light grey paste and surface*
- *Salt glaze (stipples not as prominent, but still there)*
- *Press molded or wheel thrown*
- *Salt glaze*
- *Mostly tableware and teaware forms – using same molds as creamware*
- *Decoration: molding, rouletting, rustication, some handpainting/incising*



Scratch blue white salt glaze
DAACS.org



Rusticated white salt glaze mug
Mount Vernon



Dot, diaper, basket white salt glaze flat tableware
Mount Vernon



Molded white salt glaze tablewares (basketweave, piercing, scalloped)



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Stonewares (1200°-1350°)

- **Black Basalt (1750-1820, British)**

- *Dry-bodied, i.e., not glazed - usually*
- *Grey/black paste and surface*
- *Press molded or slip cast manufacturing*
- *Sprig-molded, molded, and lathe-engine-incised decorations*
- *Usually teawares or nice tablewares*

Black Basalt mug/can



Monticello East Lawn



Black Basalt Teaware
Monticello, Building o



Black Basalt Coffee pot
Chipstone



Black Basalt creamer (note lead-glazed interior)



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Stonewares (1200°-1350°)

- **American Stoneware (1750-early 20th century)**

- *First manufactured in Yorktown, VA (early 18th c.)*
- *Various paste colors (usually darker greys and browns) and inclusion types*
- *Usually salt glaze (some alkaline glazes)*
- *Wheel thrown*
- *“Blue and Gray” handpainted decoration; some slipping*

(Amer. Stoneware paste varies, but here are some examples)



Albany-slip stoneware
Diag. MD



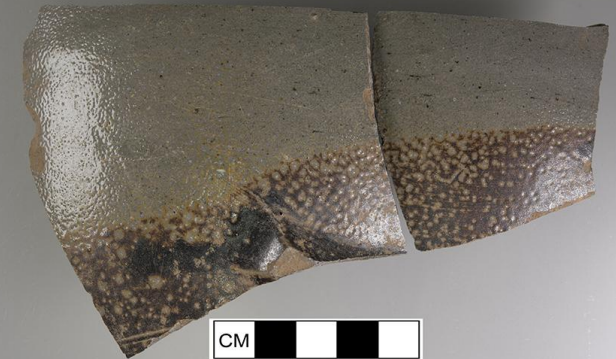
American stoneware jugs
Chipstone



American Blue & Gray sea kale pot
Monticello, MRS 2



American Stoneware
DAACS.org



American Blue & Gray
Chipstone



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Stonewares (1200°-1350°)

- **Bristol Glaze (post-1835, British/American)**

- *First manufactured in Bristol, England, adopted by Americans 1880s*
- *Tan-grey paste*
- *Wheel thrown*
- *Alkaline(-lead) glaze: opaque white applied interior/exterior & exterior top dipped in manganese/iron oxide*
- *Most commonly bottles or jugs*

Bristol Glaze Holloware
Mount Vernon



Bristol Glaze Bottle
Diag. MD

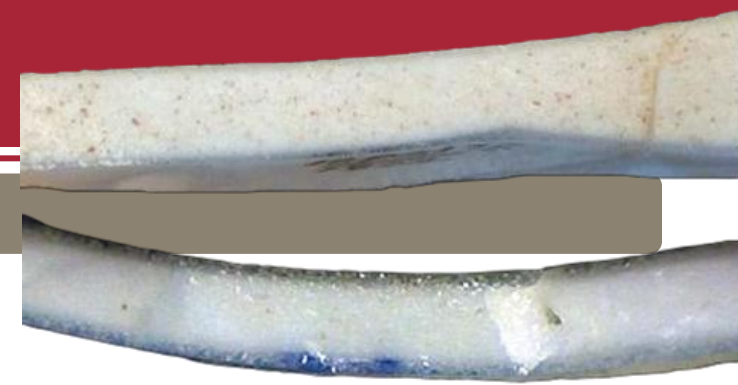


3219

Bristol Glaze Bottle
FLMNH



MATERIAL TYPE OVERVIEW



Diagnostic Artifacts
of Maryland

Porcelains (1300°-1450°)

- *Paste: vitrified (clay minerals melt and fuse together into glass-like structure)*
 - *Dense, non-porous, translucent, sharp/clean breaks, resistant to staining*
- *Glaze: Feldspathic/alkaline most common (some exceptions like soft paste and Bone China)*
 - *Glaze fuses to body*
 - *Smooth, glassy surface, sometimes with small pinholes in glaze*
- *Overglaze and underglaze decoration*

Handpainted blue Chinese porcelain plates
(c. 1690-present)
Monticello, Building o



Handpainted overglaze Chinese porcelain

(c. 1690-present)
The Hermitage, TN
(DAACS.org)



CM

Handpainted overglaze Porcellaneous/Hard
Paste (c. 1820-present)
Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland



CM

WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Diagnostic Artifacts
of Maryland

Porcelains (1300°-1450°)

- **Chinese Porcelain (c. 1690-present)**

- *European trade proliferates beginning mid-16th century*
- *Not major import to America until post-1690 via European trade networks; Americans enter trade after 1780s*
- *Vitrified, dense white/gray paste*
- *Feldspathic/alkaline glaze fuses to body*
- *Surfaces typically have blue/gray tint*
- *Handpainted decorations (over and under glaze)*

Handpainted overglaze Chinese porcelain
Monticello



Handpainted blue Chinese porcelain Wan
Li wine cup
Jamestown



Handpainted blue Chinese porcelain
plate
Monticello
Bldg o

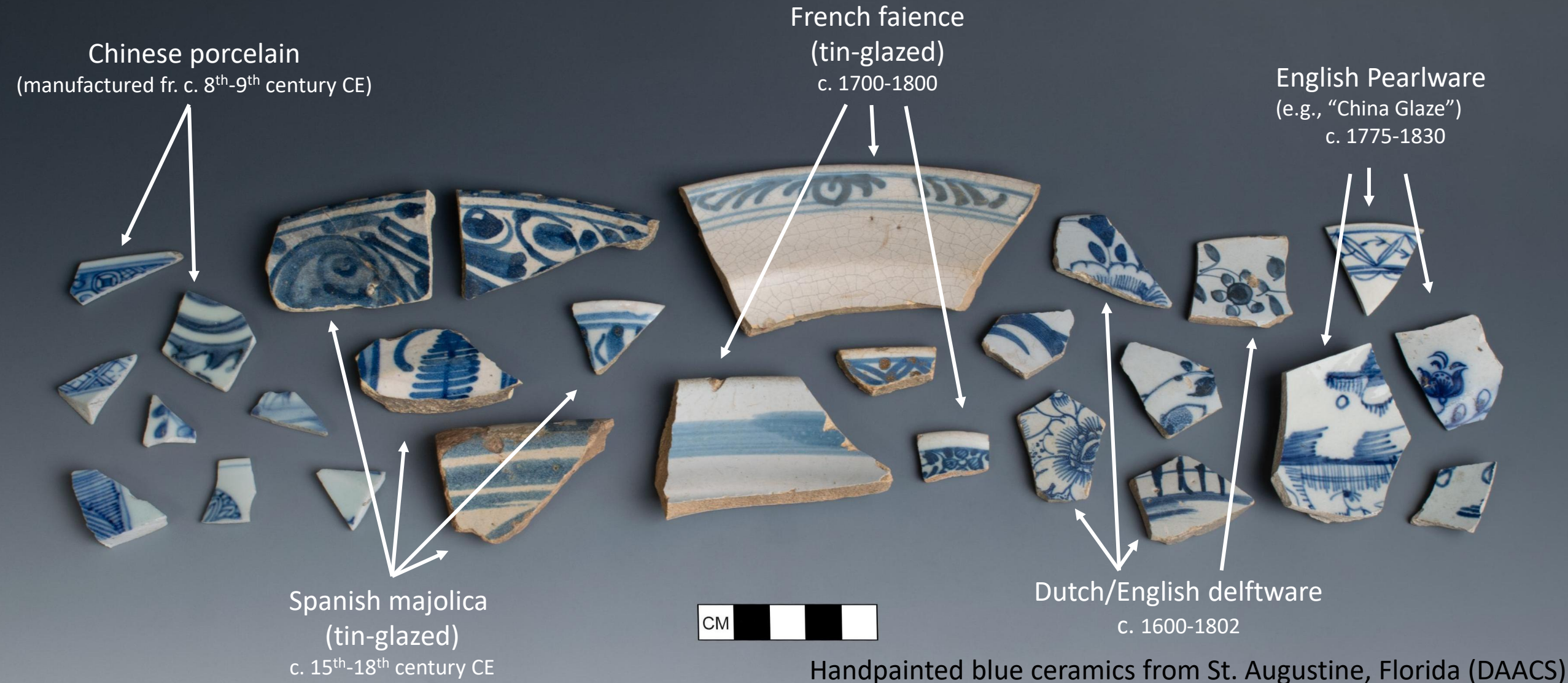


Handpainted Chinese porcelain
Swan Tavern, Charlottesville



...BRIEF INTERLUDE

The legacy of handpainted blue, origin of refined earthenwares...
and the not-to-be-understated impact of Chinese Porcelain on the global market



WARE TYPE SPOTLIGHT

Diagnostic Artifacts
of Maryland

Porcelains (1300°-1450°)

- **Porcellaneous/Hard Paste (c. 1820s-present, American/European)**

- *On British colonial sites, post-1820s contexts (albeit exceptions)*
- *European and American hard-paste*
 - *Hard-paste technology develops incrementally in Europe over course of 18th century*
- *Bright white paste and feldspathic alkaline glaze*
- *Impervious to crazing and staining*
- *Handpainted decorations (overglaze common), gilding, “decalcomania” (esp. late 19th century)*

Printed and handpainted overglaze



Printed and gilded tureen
Winterthur



Undecorated hard paste porcelain
Monticello, Joiner's Shop



Handpainted overglaze bucket for cooling
wine glasses
Monticello Curatorial Dept.



Gilded overglaze teacup
Mount Vernon



English soft paste porcelain (c. 1740s-1790s)
Monticello



English Bone China (c. 1794-present)
Monticello



English Bone China (c. 1794-present)
St. Augustine, Florida (DAACS.org)



Soft paste porcelain (c. 1794-present)
St. Augustine, Florida (DAACS.org)



Japanese Hard Paste (c. post-1870)
Monticello





Pearlware

Soft Paste

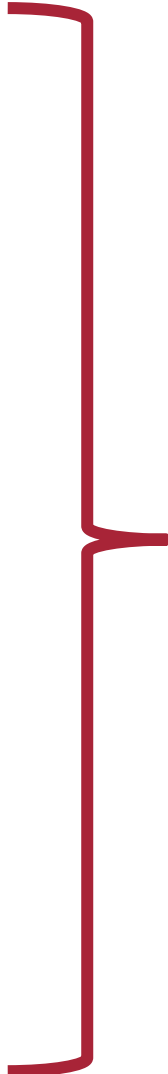
Bone China

Hard Paste
(Porcellaneous)

Chinese

GENERAL TERMS TO KNOW

- **Handpainting**
 - Underglaze
 - Overglaze
- **Transferprinting**
 - Underglaze
 - Overglaze
- **Slipping**
 - Hand-applied
 - Factory-made
- **Molding**
- **Incising**
- **Impressing (e.g., Cord-Marked)**



Types of Decorative Techniques

DECORATION HIGHLIGHTS

Factory-made Slipware

1770s-1840s



Jefferson Patterson Museum, Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland

Molded Edges



DAACS.org

Handpainting



Jefferson Patterson Museum, Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland & DAACS.org

Transferprinting

Post-1750



Jefferson Patterson Museum, Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland & DAACS.org

DECORATIVE TECHNIQUE SPOTLIGHT

Handpainted Decoration

- **Underglaze**

Whiteware “polychrome cool” (c. 1829-1920)
Diagnostic Artifacts of Maryland



Pearlware handpainted blue (1775-1830)
Monticello



Chinese porcelain handpainted blue (c. post-1690)
Monticello



Pearlware “polychrome warm” (1775-1830)
Monticello



Delftware handpainted polychrome



(c. 1600-1802)
Flowerdew Hundred, VA



American “Blue and Gray” stoneware (post-1750)
Non-archaeological

DECORATIVE TECHNIQUE SPOTLIGHT

Handpainted Decoration

• Overglaze

Chinese porcelain (c. 1690-present)
Monticello



CM

Porcellaneous/Hard Paste porcelain (c. 1820-present)
Mount Vernon



CM

Overglaze creamware (1762-1820)
Drayton Hall



Chinese porcelain (c. 1690-present)
Drayton Hall



cm

Overglaze "ghosting" on porcelain



Chinese porcelain (c. 1690-present): underglaze blue and
overglaze red enamel
Drayton Hall



DECORATIVE TECHNIQUE SPOTLIGHT

Slipped Decoration

- **Non-factory**

N. Midlands/Staffordshire Slipware (1700-1770)
Drayton Hall



American Redware (n.d.)
Monticello, Site 30



American Redware (n.d.)
Monticello



Slip Dip White Salt Glaze (1715-1775)



DECORATIVE TECHNIQUE SPOTLIGHT

Slipped Decoration

- **Factory-Made Slipware**

Mixed refined earthenwares
Swan Tavern, Cville



CM

Creamware (1762-1820)
Clagget's Brewery



cm

Pearlware (1775-1830)
Drayton Hall



Pearlware (1775-1830)
Drayton Hall



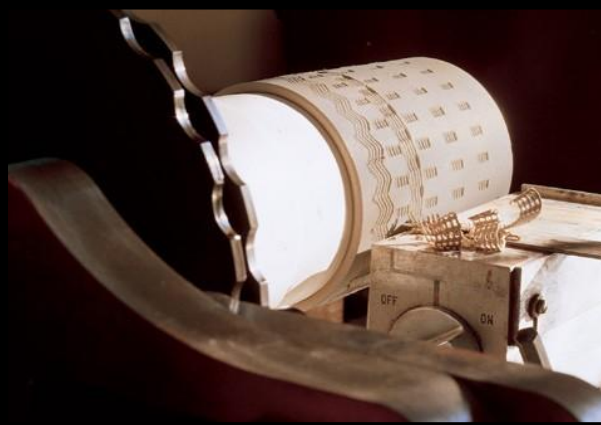
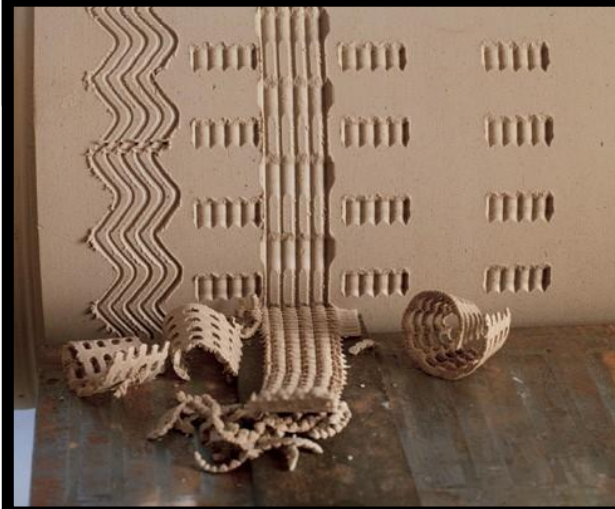
Pearlware (1775-1830)
Drayton Hall



DECORATIVE TECHNIQUE SPOTLIGHT

Slipped Decoration

- **Factory-Made Slipware**



“Slip Decoration in the Age of Industrialization”, Donald Carpentier and Jonathan Rickard, *Ceramics in America 2001*

<https://chipstone.org/article.php/9/Ceramics-in-America-2001/Slip-Decoration-in-the-Age-of-Industrialization>



DECORATIVE TECHNIQUE SPOTLIGHT

Transferprinted Decoration (over- and underglaze)

"Pinwheel" pattern (n.d.)

Pearlware platter
Non-Arch



"Chinese Men in a Garden" pattern (1794-1887)

Pearlware bowl
Drayton Hall



Unid. purple transferprint



Whiteware (1830-1870)

St. Augustine

"Phoenix" pattern (1914-c. 1950)

Japanese porcelain unid. form
Monticello



"Musketeer" pattern (1815-1842)

Pearlware jug
Drayton Hall



Black overglaze transferprint
Creamware (1762-1820)



Monticello

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TRANSFERWARE
COLLECTORS CLUB

...BRIEF INTERLUDE

Go to minutes 1:40 – 3:00 to view modern transferprinting



DECORATIVE TECHNIQUE SPOTLIGHT

Molded Decoration

Sprig-molded Frechen (German) Stoneware
(1600-1800)
Flowerdew Hundred, VA



Shell-edged pearlware (1775-1830)
St. Augustine, Florida



Feather-edged creamware (1762-1820)
Monticello



Dot, Diaper, Basketweave White Salt Glaze Stoneware (1720-1805)
Monticello



CM



Molded Black Basalt teapot and lid (1750-1820)
Monticello

CM

DECORATIVE TECHNIQUE SPOTLIGHT

Incised & Impressed Decoration

Incised Indigenous coarse earthenware
Flowerdew Hundred



Westerwald/Rhenish Stoneware (c. 1600-1775)
Incised & handpainted
Shadwell, Monticello



Fabric-impressed Indigenous coarse earthenware
Flowerdew Hundred



Cord-marked Indigenous coarse earthenware
Monticello



So WHAT...?



our resident (wet) lab rat

DATING!

- Mean Ceramic Dates (MCDs)
 - The average of the manufacturing date midpoints of all ware types in a context assemblage, weighted based on the frequency of respective ware types represented in the assemblage.
- *Terminus Post Quem* (TPQs)
 - “date after which” values calculated based on the beginning manufacturing date of the latest occurring ceramic ware type in the assemblage → represents earliest possible date of deposition for a context assemblage.

..But also: foodways, trade/systems of exchange, individual and cultural preferences

Ceramic assemblage, builder's trench for North Privy vent tunnel (1195K)
Monticello

